9 CARDS OF HORRORS

A hidden-role chase for 2–5 players, about 15 minutes

THE NIGHT SHIFT

Nobody goes down the Hollow Mine unless they have to. You did. The rent was late, the debts were older, and the company paid triple for one night of 'clearing work'. The foreman gave each of you two candles, locked the gate behind you and told you not to answer the knocking. Now the old caretaker is awake in his room at the back of the tunnels, and he is coming for you, one slow step at a time. The only key to the gate is somewhere down here.

And one of you was paid extra, up front, to make sure that not everyone comes back up.

THE GAME

A killer is walking the tunnel from left to right. Find the **Key**, reach the **Exit** and get out. But one of you may be a **Betrayer** who wants someone to die.

You need: these 9 cards, the tokens (page 4), and a six-sided die.

SETUP

- Put the **Caretaker's Room** (the Key card) **face-down** on the far left and stand the **Killer** (normal side up) on it. Put the **Exit** on the far right.
- Shuffle the other 7 scene cards. Lay 3 in a row between the Key card and the Exit. The other 4 form the **deck**.
- Flip the first card of the row face-up. All pawns start on it, front side up (ignore its text this once). Because the Killer sits on the Key card, the Key can't turn up in the row too early.
- Each player takes **2 candles**.
- **Pawns and roles:** the pawns look identical on the front; the back shows the role. Take the **Betrayer** pawn plus 1 **Survivor** pawn for every other player, shuffle them face-down, and everyone draws one and peeks at the back. Exactly one Betrayer. With 2 players, use 2 Survivor pawns.

A ROUND

Players take turns. On your turn you get **2 actions** (you may repeat one). When everyone has played, the Killer acts.

- **Move** 1 card left or right. If the card is face-down, flip it and follow its text.
- **Use** the ACTION printed on your card (search, peek...).
- **Give** any number of tokens, and/or the Key, to one player on your card (1 action), or **pick up** a dropped Key.
- **Unlock** or **Escape** at the Exit (see Winning).

Pooling: players on the same card may combine tokens (any mix) to pay one cost: searching, peeking, a dead end, Break Free, Footsteps. Surviving a kill is personal: only the victim pays, so give tokens first if you want to help.

THE KILLER (END OF EVERY ROUND)

- If players share his card, he **kills one** of them and stays put.
- Otherwise he **moves 1 card right**. At the end of round 1 he steps off the Key card onto the first card of the row. If players are on the new card, he kills one at once.
- The card he leaves is removed to a face-up pile. The exception is the Key card: while its Key is untaken, shuffle it face-down into the deck instead. A Key lying on a card he leaves moves onto the Killer's card.
- **Who dies?** Everyone on the card rolls the die. The lowest roll is the victim. On a tie, all tied players are victims. A lone player is the victim automatically.
- **Fight back:** a victim may spend **1 candle** to survive this round, or **1 flashlight** to survive and **stun** the Killer (flip him: he does nothing at the end of the next round, then flips back).
- A victim who doesn't survive becomes a **ghost**: take your pawn off the board and keep it face-down in front of you (your role still counts), drop the Key (if carried) on that card and discard all other tokens. Hand them over before it happens!

Run! If anyone is still on his card next round, he kills again.

CANDLES AND THE LIGHTER

- **Lighting:** every time you spend a candle, roll the die. On **3+** it lights and the cost is paid. On **1–2** it sputters: nothing happens, but you keep the candle. Flashlights never need a roll.
- **The lighter** (found on the Dead Miner): its holder's candles always light, no roll. Pass it on with Give.
- **Burn the Killer:** the holder may spend 1 action and roll. On **4+** the Killer is stunned, like with a flashlight. On a **1** the lighter runs empty: flip it, it is useless from now on.

FINDING THE KEY

- **Search:** in the Caretaker's Room, spend 2 candles and/or flashlights (any mix) to take the Key.
- **Dead end:** if you stand on the last card before the Exit and the Key card hasn't been revealed, spend 1 candle or 1 flashlight to add the top deck card to the row, face-down, just left of the Exit.
- **ONE USE** cards: turn them sideways once used.

GHOSTS

A ghost keeps its secret role (it still counts) and stays in the game. It cannot move, carry tokens or be killed again. On its turn it may **whisper** advice to the group (**it may lie**). Once per game it may secretly look at the top 2 cards of the deck and swap them, or leave them.

WINNING

- **Unlock:** a player on the Exit with the Key spends 1 action. The door stays open: any player on the Exit may then spend 1 action to **escape**.
- **Survivors** win if at least one Survivor escapes.
- The **Betrayer** wins if no Survivor escapes (even if he escapes himself, or is dead).
- If nobody escapes, the Killer and the Betrayer win. The game ends when every player has escaped or become a ghost. Reveal the pawns.

Bluff freely. You may say anything about your role, your tokens or the cards you have peeked at.

EXIT



Locked. Of course.

LOCKED

A player here with the Key spends 1 action to unlock the door.

OPEN

Once unlocked, any player here may spend 1 action to escape.

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CARETAKER'S ROOM



Keys rattle somewhere.

ACTION

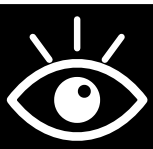
Spend 2 candles and/or flashlights to search the room. Take the Key.

THE KEY CARD

Starts face-down under the Killer. When he leaves it, shuffle it into the deck. If he passes it with the Key untaken, shuffle it back in.

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DARK PASSAGE



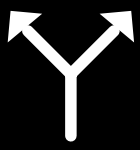
Don't look back.

ACTION

Spend 1 candle: peek at the next card to the right. Leave it, or push it to the bottom of the deck and put the top deck card there instead (face-down).

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WRONG TURN



This isn't where you came from.

ON ENTER

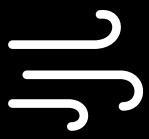
Add 2 cards from the deck to the tunnel, face-down, just left of the Exit.

DODGE

Spend 1 flashlight to ignore this.

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COLD DRAFT



A wind from nowhere.

ON ENTER

A cold wind. Roll a die: 1–4 discard 1 candle, 5–6 discard 1 flashlight. If you have none, nothing happens.

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ABANDONED CAMP



Someone left in a hurry.

ONE USE

Take 2 candles. Then turn this card sideways.

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DEAD MINER



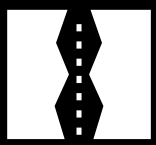
He won't need them.

ONE USE

Search the body. Take the lighter and 1 flashlight. Then turn this card sideways.

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NARROW CRAWL



Too tight. Too slow.

ON ENTER

You are stuck. You cannot move away from this card.

BREAK FREE

Spend 1 action to roll: 4+ frees you. Or spend 1 candle to free yourself at once.

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FOOTSTEPS



Closer. Closer.

WHEN REVEALED

At the end of this round the Killer moves 2 spaces instead of 1.

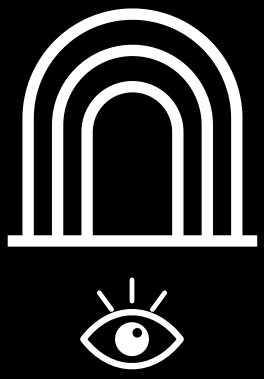
REPEL

Any player may spend 1 candle or 1 flashlight to cancel the extra step.

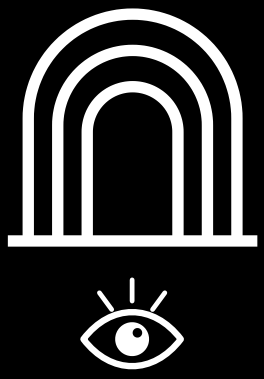
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Cards: 62 x 88 mm. Cut along the lines. Print page 3 on the back (flip on the long edge), or sleeve the cards.

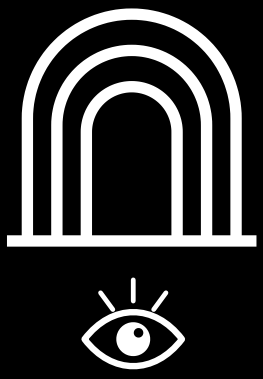
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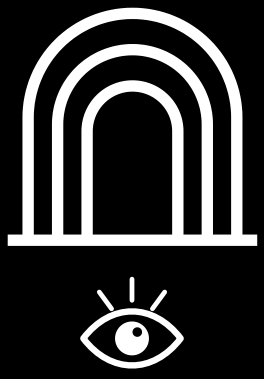
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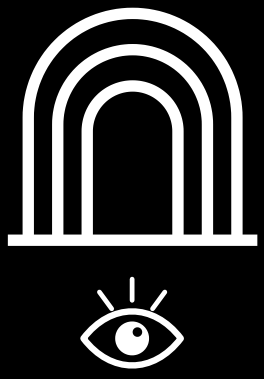
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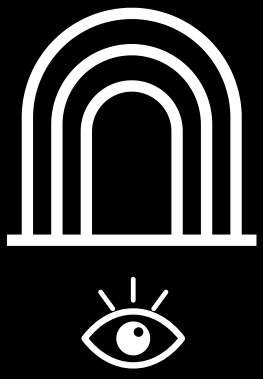
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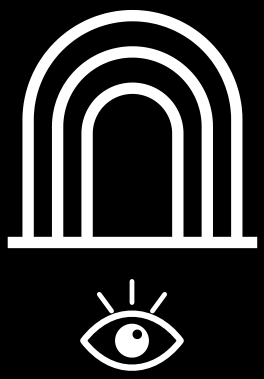
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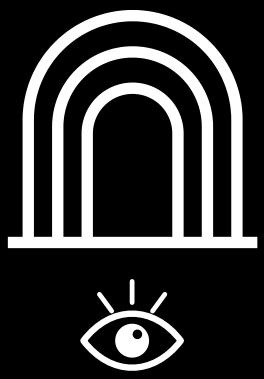
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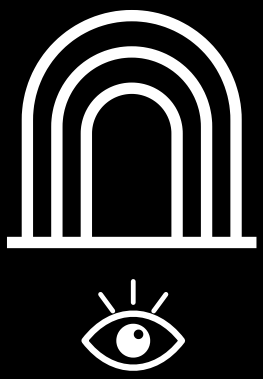
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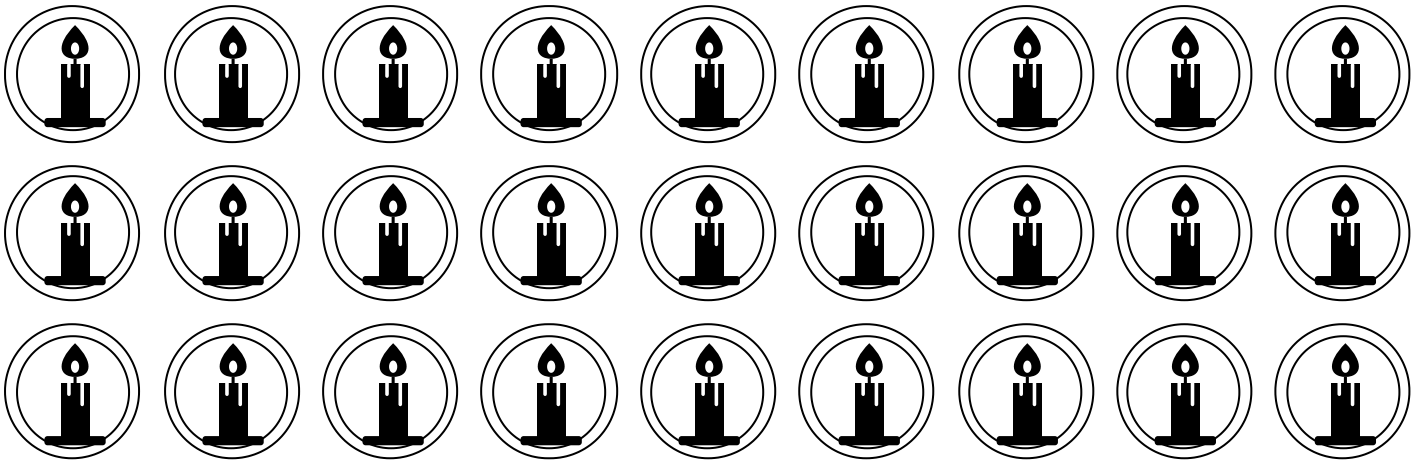


Card backs: all nine are identical.

TOKENS

Cut out along the circles. Glue the paired discs back to back (pawns, Killer, lighter), or slide them into coin sleeves.

CANDLES x27



FLASHLIGHTS x9



PAWN FRONTS x5 (identical), THE KILLER (2 sides), THE KEY, THE LIGHTER (2 sides)



PAWN BACKS (4 Survivor, 1 Betrayer): glue each behind a front, then shuffle. The empty lighter goes behind the lighter.



TOKENS AT A GLANCE

Candle: survive a kill for one round. Peek (Dark Passage). Break free (Narrow Crawl). Roll 3+ to light it (no roll for the lighter's holder).

Flashlight: survive a kill *and* stun the Killer. Ignore Wrong Turn.

Candle or flashlight: search the Caretaker's Room (2 of them). Add a card at a dead end (1). Cancel the Footsteps extra step (1).

Key: found in the Caretaker's Room. Carry it to the Exit. If its carrier dies it drops on that space. If the Killer passes it, it moves onto his space.

Lighter: found on the Dead Miner. Its holder's candles always light. Burn the Killer: 1 action, roll 4+ to stun him; on a 1 it is empty.

Pooling: players on the same card can chip in tokens together to pay one cost. A victim pays alone to survive a kill.

Stun: flip the Killer to his stunned side. At the end of the next round he does nothing (no move, no kill), then flips back.

Start: every player has 2 candles, no flashlights, no lighter, no Key.